Faraya Lodge

A small guesthouse in the mountains of Faraya, Lebanon

Our story

We're Rami and Maya Haddad, brother and sister. Our family has had a stone house in Faraya for as long as we can remember, and we spent most of our childhood winters and summers there, skiing when there was snow and hiking when there wasn't. In 2021 we decided the house deserved better than sitting empty most of the year. We spent a year restoring it, and in December 2022 we opened the doors as Faraya Lodge.

It's a small place, eight rooms in total, and we like it that way. When you arrive, it's one of us who greets you, and it's Maya who cooks your breakfast. We wanted a place where people feel like they're staying with friends in the mountains, not checking into a hotel. Faraya is about an hour's drive from Beirut, depending on traffic, which makes it easy for a weekend away.

The rooms

We have four Standard Double rooms, two Mountain-View Suites and two Family Rooms. The standard rooms have either a double bed or two twin beds and their own bathroom. The suites are our favourites: a king bed, a fireplace and a private balcony looking out over the mountains. The family rooms have one double bed and two single beds and sleep up to four people. Every room has central heating and free Wi-Fi, and there's free parking outside.

Standard Double Room (up to 2 guests)	$70 per night
Mountain-View Suite (up to 2 guests)	$95 per night
Family Room (up to 4 guests)	$120 per night

Prices are per room, in US dollars, and include breakfast. They stay the same all year. Children under 6 stay free in their parents' room.

What you'll find at the lodge

Every room has its own bathroom with hot water around the clock, towels, shampoo and soap, and a hairdryer. There's also an electric kettle with tea and coffee and a small fridge. We decided not to put TVs in the rooms; the views do a better job.

The rooms don't have their own kitchen or stove, but downstairs there's a shared guest kitchenette that you're welcome to use between 8 AM and 10 PM. It has a gas stove, a microwave, a fridge, and pots, pans and dishes. Next to it is the lounge, with a wood-burning fireplace, board games and a shelf of books.

We have electricity 24 hours a day, thanks to a backup generator and solar panels, so you won't have to deal with power cuts. We can do your laundry for $8 a load. If you're coming with a baby, just ask and we'll add a crib to your room for free. Two of our Standard Double rooms are on the ground floor, for anyone who'd rather avoid stairs. Parking is free. We don't offer airport transfers; most of our guests drive up from Beirut.

Food

Breakfast is served every morning between 7:30 and 10:30 and is included in the room price. It's a proper Lebanese breakfast: man'oushe, labneh, cheese, eggs, fresh vegetables and fruit. Maya trained as a chef, and she also cooks a home-style Lebanese dinner for anyone who wants it. Dinner is a set menu served at one big table, and it costs $18 per person. We just ask that you let us know by 4 PM on the same day so she can plan.

Winter at the lodge

Most of our winter guests come for the skiing. We run a shuttle to the Mzaar slopes every day of the ski season, in the morning and the afternoon, for $10 per person per day. If you don't have your own gear, our partner shop in Faraya rents skis and snowboards for $20 a day and we can arrange it for you. For something quieter, Karim takes guests snowshoeing for $15 per person, snowshoes included. In the evenings we light the fire in the lounge, and that part is free.

Summer at the lodge

Faraya in summer is green, cool and a nice escape from the heat on the coast. Karim leads half-day hikes around the area for $15 per person. He also does a half-day tour of the Faqra Roman ruins and the Natural Bridge (Jisr el Hajar) for $25 per person. When the sky is clear we put out chairs on the terrace for stargazing, which is free for all our guests.

Who you'll meet

Rami looks after bookings, the day-to-day running of the lodge and our partners in the village. Before Faraya Lodge he worked in hotel management in Beirut for eight years. Maya takes care of the guests and the kitchen, and she designed both our breakfast and dinner menus. Karim is our mountain guide. He grew up in Faraya, he's a certified ski instructor, and he leads all our hikes, snowshoe outings and tours. Online, you'll mostly talk to Nadine, our virtual host, who answers questions and passes booking requests on to Rami.

A few house rules

Check-in is from 2 PM and check-out is by 11 AM. We're open all year round. To confirm a booking we ask for a 30% deposit, and the rest is paid when you arrive, either in cash (US dollars) or by card. You can cancel for free up to 48 hours before you arrive; after that, the deposit isn't refunded. We don't allow pets, and the lodge is non-smoking inside.

Booking a stay

The easiest way is to leave your name, email and dates with Nadine. Rami will email you within 24 hours to confirm whether the room is free and to sort out the deposit. Nadine can't see live availability herself, so she can't confirm a booking on the spot.

Questions people often ask us

How far is it from Beirut? About an hour by car, depending on traffic.

How close are the slopes? Mzaar is a short drive away, and our shuttle goes there every day during the ski season.

Is breakfast included? Yes, with every room.

Can we bring our dog? Unfortunately not, we don't allow pets.

Do you take cards? Yes. The balance can be paid on arrival by card or in cash (US dollars).

We hope to welcome you up in Faraya soon.
Rami and Maya